

μRPG Basic Rules

By Joe Kelly

Using These Rules

Everything you need to know to start playing μ RPG is laid out by way of example here, we follow the lvl. 6 character: Vlad.

Name: Vlad

Background: Noble

Species: Daemon

A contest check works the same way as a skill check, except both parties roll and the highest result wins.

The Storyteller

One player is the storyteller. They describe the world, play everyone in it, set the difficulty of every check, and decide which skill applies.

A Worked Check

Vlad climbs a steep cliff. The storyteller decides an average person would fail five times in ten, so the difficulty is 50, and Con is the skill. Con sits under Strength, which is 6, and Vlad has 1 pip in Con.

He rolls 44, adds 5 for the pips and 6 for Strength, giving 55. That beats 50, so he makes it.

Abbreviations

All skills and attributes are abbreviated to three letters.

Two pairs need care: Chr is Charisma the attribute and Cha is Charm the skill, and Prc is Perception while Prf is Performance.

Skill Checks

Primary Strength 6

Physical

Constitution 000

Dexterity 7

Align 000

Finesse 000

Mental

Intelligence 7

Science 000

Esoterica 000

Investigation 000

Charisma 15

Charm 000

Performance 000

Any non-combat action that has a chance of failing requires a skill check. The difficulty of this check should be set by the storyteller as the percentage chance that an average person would fail said action. The storyteller also decides which skill from a player's sheet is most relevant to the check.

The player then rolls a d100 (2d10 where one is the units and one is the tens) and adds 5 to this total for each pip in the skill itself and any skills downstream of it, they also add the attribute value of any connected primary skill. If this total beats the percentage, they succeed. A player may suggest the substitution of one skill for another in any roll.

Composite

Rifles 000

Vampirism 000

Medicine 000

Synthetic

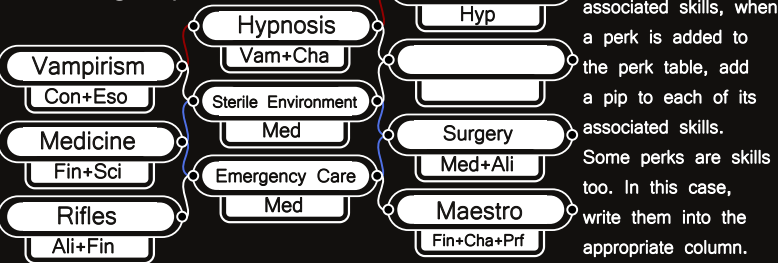
Surgery 000

Hypnosis 000

Maestro 000

If a player has a perk in the perk table, they may use any ability associated with that perk as detailed in its perk pack.

Levelling Up



Upon levelling up, a player is given 3 perk points to spend. They may select any perk from any perk pack the storyteller has pre-approved and place it in the perk table, so long as they meet the prerequisites and can pay the perk point cost for it. Most perks come as part of perk trees, meaning part of their prerequisites is that the previous perks on the branch have been taken. In this case, the perks must be placed in the perk table connected in the same way as they are in the perk tree. If a perk cannot fit in the perk table, then the perk cannot be taken.

Inventory Management

Str

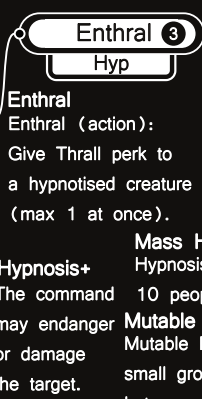
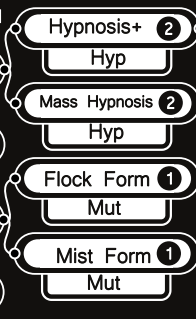
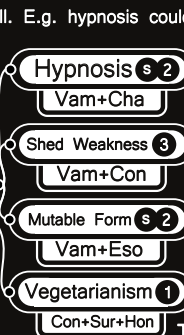
2				
4				
6				
8	X	X	X	X

Tetrimino icons: I, O, T, L, S, Z, X

All carryable or wearable items have an associated tetrimino. To carry or wear these items a player must fit their tetriminos somewhere in the inventory grid. The number of rows of the inventory grid available to a player depends on their characters strength score. Item details should be written on a card - if this is lost then the player character loses the item in-game.

Example Perk Tree: Vampirism

C marks a composite skill and **S** marks a synthetic skill. These skills are not just relevant for the actions each perk gives you access to. They can be used as a regular skill. E.g. hypnosis could be used in a social situation to help persuade someone without explicitly hypnotising them and Mutable Form could be used to attempt to disguise yourself.



Hypnosis
Hypnosis (action): compel a creature to perform a short task (Hyp contest vs. Hon or equivalent). The task mustn't endanger or harm the target.

Mass Hypnosis
Hypnosis may now target up to 10 people at once.

Mutable Form
Mutable Form (action): Become a small grotesque creature such as a bat or rat. All physical checks while in this form are replaced with Mut.

Vampirism

Feed (action): make a finesse check against the AC (♥) of a creature next to you. This check automatically succeeds if the target is not aware of you. On success deal 2d10 sharp dmg and regain that many Hp (♥).

Enhancements (passive): Str+5, Dex+5

Immune to poison and radiation damage.

Weaknesses (passive): you are unable to cross moving water, garlic exposure deals 1d10 radiant dmg to you, and sunlight exposure deals 10d10 radiant dmg to you.

Thrall

The same as vampirism with none of the weaknesses. You may not progress along the vampirism perks.

Enthralled (passive): you must obey the vampire that enthralled you. Hon (or equivalent) check @ 90% to resist.

Vegetarianism
Lose both the Enhancements and weaknesses of Vampirism. You may still feed on animals for the same healing effect.

Shed Weakness Lose weaknesses from Vampirism, except garlic exposure. damaged and can fit through tiny gaps.

Example Item Cards

(If an item card has no tetromino as its suit it is free to carry)



Kinetic Plate

Passive: Add 40 to AC.

Action: Half incoming blunt dmg and add a count to the counter (max of 3). This action can be taken even if it is not your turn.

Action: Spend up to 3 counts and add that many d10 sonic dmg to your next dmg roll.



Laser Rifle



Fire (action): Attempt to hit target with a laser (Align vs. target AC, range 50). On success, deal 1d10 + Dexterity thermal dmg to the target.



Attacking

Most attacks in **MRPG** come from an item card or a perk, each of which states its own skill, range and damage. A character without a suitable weapon or combat perk can instead make an Improvised Attack. This is a straight roll with no bonuses Vs. AC and deals 1d10 blunt damage on a success.

Damage types: blunt, sharp, sonic, thermal, electrical, chemical, poison, radiation, radiant, entropic, psychic.

Character Creation

1. Choose a name.
2. Roll 1d10 to determine each attribute's value.
3. Choose a Species.
4. Choose a background.
5. Gain and spend 2 perk points.
6. Fill in combat stats.
7. Draw character portrait.
8. Set lvl to 1.

Although species and background have a mechanical impact, the primary focus of your choice as a player should be the role play impact of these aspects of your character.

At the beginning of combat all players and enemies will roll 1d10 and add their initiative () score to it. Play then proceeds in initiative order. On a turn, a player is given 3 actions to take these can be from a perk, an item, or to perform a skill check. Unspent actions are kept until a player's next turn.

Combat

(Str+Con)

53

42

7

Hp

Current

Temp.

Dex

Combat Grid

Combat may optionally take place on a square grid. In this case place any characters, enemies, and terrain in an appropriate place on the grid. All movements, ranges, and other lengths in this game are defined as the number of squares they take up on this grid.

Taking Damage

When a player sustains damage, their HP reduces by that amount. For every HP below their maximum, they suffer a -1 penalty to all checks. If their HP reduces to 0, they fall unconscious and can take no actions.

Recovery

A character at 0 Hp regains consciousness with 1 Hp after 1d10 hours, or as soon as healing is applied to them. A resting character recovers 1 Hp per hour. Temporary Hp is tracked separately from current Hp, and is always removed first when a character takes damage.

Basic Species

- Human**
+5 to 2 separate attributes and start with 1 extra perk point.
- Synth**
+8 to Intelligence and +3 to Dexterity.
- Android**
+6 to Strength and add a pip to Con.
- Spacer (Uncommon)**
+8 to Dexterity, -2 to Strength (min 1), and +5 to Intelligence.
- Crystalline (Rare)**
+11 to Strength.
- Fae/Daemon (Rare)**
+6 to Charisma and add a pip to Cha.

Levelling

A character levels up when the storyteller says they do. There is no experience total to track. As a guide, levelling every few sessions keeps perk trees growing at a pace players can feel without outrunning the equipment they find.

Example Backgrounds

Backgrounds are what you were doing, not necessarily what you are doing now.

Noble Add a pip to one of Cul or Sci and one to Prf.	Scholar Add a pip to two of Cul, Sci and Eso.	Devout Add a pip to Eso and Hon.	Criminal Add a pip to Fin and Ste.	Soldier Add 2 pips to one of For or Ali.	Artist Add a pip to Prc and Prf.	Outlander Add a pip to Con and Sur.
Citizen Add a pip to one Mental skill and one Physical skill.						

